



INDIA, WHICH SURPASSED China to become the most populous nation in the world last April, recently received some wonderful news. The country, which currently has a population of 1.4 billion but has struggled with unemployment for a long time, saw its unemployment rate decline to 3.2%, the lowest level in at least five years, per the Periodic Labour Force

Survey (PLFS) 2022-23. Additionally, both the labour force participation rate and worker-population ratio have increased.

More recent PLFS data for the July-September 2023 quarter also showed a similar picture with the unemployment rate in urban areas stagnant at 6.6% from a high of 12.6% in April-June 2022.

“India does not have a jobs problem, but a wages problem,” says Manish Sabharwal, Co-founder & Vice Chairman of TeamLease Services, a leading staffing services provider. “The government must have a strategy to ensure at least 2.5-3 million high-quality jobs annually that pay more than ₹50,000 per month are created,” adds Mohandas Pai, Chairman of

A SNAPSHOT

1.4

BILLION
INDIA'S POPULATION

574

MILLION
INDIA'S WORKFORCE, 41%
OF WHICH IS EMPLOYED, AS
PER PLFS 2022-23

262

MILLION
AGRICULTURAL JOBS,
ACCOUNTING FOR 45.8%
OF THE WORKFORCE, AS
PER PLFS 2022-23

65

MILLION
MANUFACTURING JOBS,
WHICH IS 11.4% OF THE
WORKFORCE, AS PER
PLFS 2022-23

247

MILLION
ALL OTHER JOBS, INCLUDING
WHITE-COLLAR AND
CORPORATE ONES; THESE CAN
BE FURTHER CLASSIFIED AS: 5
MILLION IT AND IITES JOBS; 1.5
MILLION START-UP JOBS; 25
MILLION GOVERNMENT JOBS

7.7

MILLION
THE SIZE OF GIG WORKFORCE
IN INDIA, AS PER NITI AAYOG

NOTE THE PLFS DATA USED
IS THE USUAL STATUS OR AN-
NUAL DATA. THE DATA CON-
SIDERED IS AT THE ALL-INDIA
LEVEL, RURAL AND URBAN,
AND MALE AND FEMALE

4 The connection between growth and good jobs remains weak, per a report by Azim Premji University

5 The government must focus on more industry jobs for those migrating out of farms and expand high-paying jobs